



CRACKING THE CODE

► AI NOT ONLY AFFECTS INDIVIDUALS, BUT ALSO COMMUNITIES AND SOCIETY

► DATA ITSELF CANNOT MAKE DECISIONS, SO AI SYSTEMS NEED INTERVENTION AND CHECKS AT ALL LEVELS

► COMPANIES INFUSE A LOT OF DATA FROM DIFFERENT SOURCES INTO AI SYSTEMS, BUT FAIL TO ANALYSE AND UTILISE THEM BASED ON THE FEATURE THEY ARE TRYING TO CAPTURE

► TRUSTWORTHY AI STANDARDS ARE LEFT TO THE DISCRETION OF THE PEOPLE WHO WRITE AND DEPLOY AN ORGANISATION'S AI ALGORITHMIC MODELS, MAKING IT IMPERATIVE FOR THIS COMMUNITY TO BE EDUCATED ON THE ETHICAL AND SUSTAINABLE USE OF DATA SETS

► RESPONSIBLE AI IS NOT MAGIC. IT MEANS CONDENSING VARIOUS DATA SETS ACCORDING TO WHAT HAS HAPPENED TO IDENTIFY ISSUES AND TAKE STEPS TO ELIMINATE THEM

This is exactly what happened in Amazon's case. It had been fed data from a time when the industry was dominated by male candidates. And the AI was showing the results based on the inputs it had got. To solve this, Ankit Bose, Nasscom's AI Head, suggests that start-ups should try to understand the biases in data so well that they start creating their own data sets at the source level.

THE SELF-REGULATION KEY

Currently, there are many tools available (from Microsoft, Google, etc.) to check the performance of AI systems, but there is no regulatory oversight. And that is why, experts believe that companies, new and old, need to put more thought into self-regulation.

For instance, tech giant TCS' strategy has been to do pilots with many players, along with regular audits of its processes to refine its RAI models. "This has created an API-fied version of a tool that is extensible, fungible and applies to different types of AI models like computer vision, natural language processing, sequence to sequence models, etc.," says Lodha.

Another way to carry out checks and balances is through thorough audits. "A regular audit of their processes and timely validation of compliance to any changes in standards in the RAI space is required," says Lodha. He also cites the European Commission's High-Level Expert Group on AI's ethics guidelines, or America's National AI Initiative's Strategic Pillars as good reference points to start with.

Tech giants apart, there are also some well-known start-ups that have carved out ways to implement RAI. Monish Darda, CTO and Co-founder of SaaS unicorn Icertis—that provides contract lifecycle management (CLM) solutions—says a few years ago, they integrated Explainable AI and Ethical AI into their AI systems. Explainable AI allows Icertis to explain the results produced by their AI, enabling the correlation between the result and the data that produced it. "This has worked very well for us because we get to know how we arrived at a prediction and what we missed," he says. Ethical AI, meanwhile, helps Icertis assure its users and customers that the data used in training its AI tools is sourced with permission and for the purpose it was intended. The platform also ensures that the data set is unbiased by picking up a reasonable sample of the data after considering aspects like geographies, culture, etc.

Not only that, there is a huge thrust on engaging people from different domains to make fair and just AI systems. "To push the positive applications of